

Shayan Abbasi

Ph.D. Candidate @ McMaster University

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Data Scientist specializing in **causal inference**, **A/B testing**, and **marketing analytics** (MMM, multi-touch attribution, marketing measurement), with applied experience in **NLP**, **RAG**, and **Agentic AI** workflows.

EDUCATION

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- Ph.D. in Business Administration - Quantitative Marketing*** Aug 2022 – Dec 2026
McMaster University - DeGroote School of Business Hamilton, ON
- **Dissertation:** *Threats and Adaptations in Digital Platforms: Essays on Strategy Across the Ecosystem*
 - **Essay 1:** Competing with the Platform: Complementor's Privacy Policy Response to Platform-Owner Entry – **NLP text analysis** and a **difference-in-differences / event-study** design examining complementors' privacy-disclosure responses to platform-owner entry.
 - **Essay 2:** Beyond the Gimmick: How Conversational AI is Reshaping E-Commerce Platform Dynamics – measures how generative AI shopping assistants and **LLM-driven workflows** affect consumer-product matching and post-purchase ratings.
 - **Essay 3:** Selling the Teacher: AI API Pricing under Endogenous Knowledge Distillation – pricing model for LLM API access under the threat of customer knowledge distillation.
- Master of Applied Economics*** Sep 2021 – Jul 2022
Autonomous University of Barcelona Barcelona, Spain
- Thesis: Market Share Analysis in U.S. Markets.
- Master of Financial Economics*** Sep 2020 – Jul 2021
Barcelona School of Economics Barcelona, Spain
- Master Thesis: The financial consequences of corporate misconduct: A financial event study analysis.
- Bachelor of Economics (Minor in Computer Science)*** Sep 2016 – Jul 2020
University of Tehran Tehran, Iran
- Graduated with Honors; served as Teaching Assistant for Applied Programming and Introduction to Programming (Python).

CONFERENCES AND PUBLICATIONS

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- Competing with the Platform: Complementor's Privacy Policy Response to Platform-Owner Entry:** ISMS 2026 (Lisbon, Portugal), TPM 2026 (Barcelona, Spain), EMAC 2026 (Bath, UK), ASAC 2026 (Calgary, AB).
- Investor Reactions to Corporate Social Irresponsibility: A Meta-Analysis of Financial Market Event Studies:** MSMW 2026 (San Antonio, TX), CCBRS 2025 (Hamilton, ON), TPM 2024 (Austin, TX), DeGroote Marketing BBL 2024 (Hamilton, ON).
- Professional Development & Attendance:** AMS 2025 Conference and Doctoral Symposium (Montreal, QC); ET Symposium 2025 for Canadian Marketing Strategy (Guelph, ON).

EXPERIENCE

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- Sessional Instructor, Marketing Research (MBA)** Sep 2026 – Dec 2026
DeGroote School of Business, McMaster University Hamilton, Canada
- Designing and delivering the graduate **Marketing Research** curriculum (M731) for MBA students, covering research design, marketing measurement, and applied analytics.
- Sessional Instructor, Introduction to Marketing** Sep 2025 – Jan 2026
DeGroote School of Business, McMaster University Hamilton, Canada
- Designed and delivered the full curriculum for **Introduction to Marketing**, including tutorials and assessments for undergraduate students, focused on **scenario-based** learning.
- Teaching Assistant** Sep 2022 – Sep 2026
DeGroote School of Business, McMaster University Hamilton, Canada
- Facilitated learning for: **1MA3** - Introduction to Marketing, **3MA3** - Marketing Research, **M731** - Marketing Research (MBA), **BL653** - Intermediate Marketing (Exec. MBA), and **T712** - Strategic Marketing (Exec. MBA).
- Data Scientist** Apr 2025 – Dec 2025
Shannon School of Business Sydney, NS

- Executed **sentence classification** experiments using **Zero-Shot classification** (BART, ModernBERT) and Gemini models with batching and sample packing.

Data Scientist

Jan 2024 – Jun 2025

United For Iran

San Francisco, USA

- Developed **dynamic geospatial dashboards** using Plotly, GeoPandas, and NetworkX for high-resolution spatial analysis of agent activity.
- Implemented **anomaly detection** and behavioral clustering (K-Means, GMM), identifying user behavior.
- Synthesized complex spatial and behavioral data into actionable technical reports for **cross-functional stakeholders**, translating findings into resource-optimization strategies.

Research Assistant

Dec 2024 – Jan 2025

McMaster University

Hamilton, Canada

- Engineered **fuzzy matching workflow** for disparate datasets, streamlining data preparation for longitudinal research.

Quant Developer

Oct 2020 – Dec 2020

Stealth Startup

Tehran, Iran

- Automated large-scale **data ingestion** and cleaning for panel datasets to ensure data integrity.
- Implemented arbitrage strategies, Monte Carlo backtesting, and grid strategy for **high-frequency trading** models.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages & Libraries: Python (PyTorch, Scikit-Learn, Pandas, NumPy, Statsmodels, GeoPandas, NetworkX), SQL, LaTeX

Causal Inference & Marketing Analytics: A/B Testing & Experimental Design, Difference-in-Differences, Event Study Analysis, Panel Data Regression, Marketing Mix Modeling (MMM), Multi-Touch Attribution, Marketing Measurement

AI, LLM & Agent Frameworks: LangGraph, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Agentic AI Workflows, Large Language Models (LLMs), API Pricing, Prompt Engineering, Zero-Shot Classification (BART, ModernBERT, Gemini)

Finance & Quantitative Methods: High-Frequency Trading Models, Financial Event Studies, Portfolio Backtesting, Monte Carlo Simulations

Platforms & Tools: GCP (Vertex AI), Git, Docker, Linux/Unix

HONORS & AWARDS

- Ph.D. Office (DSB) Scholarship, McMaster University – \$60,000 (2022–2026).
- DeGroote Distinguished Student Award – \$10,000 (2022–2026).
- DeGroote Supervisor Student Support – \$13,900 (2022–2026).
- University of Tehran - Hami Scholarship for Distinguished Students (2019-2020).